

CURRICULUM VITAE

Joy Lee-Shi

jleeshi@outlook.com

Additional Languages: Mandarin (Conversational), Spanish (Basic Conversational)

EDUCATION

- 2023 – 2025 **Master of Arts, Experimental Psychology (History, Quantitative, Theoretical Specialization)**
Simon Fraser University (SFU), Burnaby, BC, Canada
Thesis: *Adversity and Trauma: Examining and Elaborating the Hybrid Model of Stress Response as Applied to Belizean Contexts*
Supervisor: Dr. Robert G. Ley
- 2018 – 2022 **Bachelor of Arts, Psychology (Honours with Distinction)**
Simon Fraser University (SFU), Burnaby
Thesis: *Differences in Flow State and Flow Disposition in Jazz vs. Classical Musicians and their Practice*
Supervisor: Dr. Robert G. Ley
- 2016 – 2018 **Associate of Science, Pure Mathematics**
St. John's College Junior College (SJCJC), Belize

CERTIFICATES / LICENSES

- 07/2025 **Teaching License**, Level: Secondary [Education] – Counselling, Belize
Ministry of Education, Expires 07/2027, ID: BZ-2025-00046
- 05/2025 **Peer Navigator** (for providing HIV Voluntary Counselling), GOJoven
Belize Alumni Association (GOBelize)
- 2024, 2020 **TCPS 2: CORE** (Tri-Council Policy Statement: Ethical Conduct for
Research Involving Humans Course on Research Ethics)

SCHOLARSHIPS, AWARDS AND GRANTS

- 2025 Selected Author, The Annual Celebration of SFU Authors 2024, SFU
- 2023 – 2024 Graduate Fellowship, SFU (\$14,000 CAD)
- 2023 – 2024 Special Graduate Entrance Scholarship, SFU (\$5,000 CAD)
- 2024 Honourable Mention Winner for Best Psychology Data Blitz Presentation,
Criminal Minds 2024 – An Interdisciplinary Conference, SFU
- 2022, 2020 President's Honour Roll, SFU
- 2022, 2020,
2019 Dean's Honour Roll, SFU
- 2021 Undergraduate Open Scholarship, SFU (\$990 CAD)
- 2016 – 2018 Dean's Honour List, SJCJC
- 2016 National 1st Place in Mathematics, Association of Tertiary Level
Institutions in Belize (ATLIB)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

02/2026 – 04/2026	Conference Organizer , St John's College - University, Emerging Scholars Conference
08/2025 – 12/2025	Special Education Resource Teacher , Itz'at STEAM Academy, Belize • Curated evidence-based materials for student accommodations • Develop and deliver a course, Student Inclusion & Learning, to 1st/2nd years (6 classrooms), using evidence-based frameworks
08/2024 – Present	Peer Reviewer , Journal of Belizean Research
03/2024 – 10/2025	Graduate Reviewer , SFU, Undergraduate Journal of Psychology
01/2025 – 05/2025	Conference Organizer , SFU, Psychological Methods in Action: PSYC 201W Spring Conference
07/2024 – 04/2025	Experimental Psychology Departmental Representative , SFU, Psychology Graduate Caucus

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

08/2026 – Present	Principal Investigator , <i>Mental Health, Coping, Grit, and Perceived Stress Among Tertiary-Level Students in Belize</i> , University of Belize Co-Principal Investigator: Mathias R. Vairez Jr., PhD • Lead a study (target N = 600) on mental health, coping, grit, and perceived stress among tertiary-level students in Belize • Develop and maintain the study website, online survey, and digital recruitment resources
07/2026 – Present	Freelance Statistical Analyst , Belize • Conduct analyses for PhD research on Child Protective Services (CPS) Workers' experiences with stress, burnout, and trauma
09/2025 – Present	Co-Author & Statistical Analyst , Belize National Association of Social Workers (BNASW), Belize • Lead the design, analysis, and report writing for a nationwide needs assessment survey
07/2025 – Present	Co-Author & Statistical Analyst , Indigenous Peoples Participation in Higher Education Project (IPinHE) – Belizean Branch Principal Investigator: Dr. Filiberto Penados • Conducted statistical analyses and produced a 77-page report
2022 – 2023	Literature Review Assistant , Dr. Robert G. Ley • Conducted scoping reviews in support of forensic clinical psychological expert witness evaluations and reports
2021 – 2023	Research Assistant , SFU, Attention Lab Lab Director: Dr. Thomas Spalek • Lead participant intake and debriefing for Evaluative Space Model and Flanker studies

- 2020 – 2023 **Research Assistant**, SFU, Measurement and Modelling Lab
 Lab Director: Dr. Rachel T. Fouladi
- Transcribed 40+ audio-recorded interviews (30–80 minutes each)
 - Supported 3 Master’s students’ projects through qualitative coding and thematic analysis of interview data using NVivo and Excel
- 2022 – 2023 **Researcher**, <https://jls-bz.github.io/>
 Topic: *Text-Based Big-Data Analyses on Discussions of Dissociation*
- Developed Python / R scripts to web-scrape and clean Reddit posts
 - Using Natural Language Processing tools, analyzed text-based big-data via Topic Modelling with Term-Frequency Inverse Document Frequency and Latent Dirichlet Allocation

BOOKS & BOOK CHAPTERS [2]

2. Young, L., & **Lee-Shi, J.** (2026). *Psychological First Aid for Young Peers: A Handbook*. Belize City Lions Club Mental Health Committee.
1. **Lee-Shi, J.** (2024). In the Zone: Understanding the Mystique of Flow. In D. Lacey & **J. Lee-Shi** (Eds.), *Beautiful Belize City* (pp. 36-37). Yaoling Lee.

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS [3]

3. Young, L., & **Lee-Shi, J.** (accepted). Boots on the Ground, Cracks in the System: BDF Mental Health and Wellbeing. *Keeping Independence Alive: Belize @45*.
2. Penados, F., Rosado, L., Tzib, D., **Lee-Shi, J.**, & Gonzalez, G. N. (2026). Indigenous Peoples Participation in Higher Education in Belize: Present Realities and its Implications for Policy and Practice. *Ichan Tecolotl*, 400.
<https://ichan.ciesas.edu.mx/indigenous-peoples-participation-in-higher-education-in-belize-present-realities-and-its-implication-for-policy-and-practice/>
1. **Lee-Shi, J.**, & Ley, R. G. (2022). A Critique of the Dispositional Flow Scale-2 (DFS-2) and Flow State Scale-2 (FSS-2). *Frontiers in Psychology*, 13.
<https://www.frontiersin.org/articles/10.3389/fpsyg.2022.992813>

CONFERENCES & SYMPOSIUMS [13]

13. Vairez, M., & **Lee-Shi, J.** (2026, September). *Grit, Mental Health, and Pandemic Related Adversity Among Adolescents in Belize*. The Belize-Mexico Binational Seminar, Belize.
12. Vairez, M., & **Lee-Shi, J.** (2026, September). *Validating the Short Grit Scale (Grit-S) with a Sample of Adolescents in Belize*. The Belize-Mexico Binational Seminar, Belize.
11. Young, L., & **Lee-Shi, J.** (2026, September). *Boots on the Ground, Cracks in the System: BDF Mental Health and Wellbeing*. Keeping Independence Alive: Belize @45, Belize Policy Research Institute (BELPRI), Belize.
10. Penados, F., Rosado, L., **Lee-Shi, J.**, Tzib, D., & Gonzalez, N. G. (2025, October). *Indigenous Peoples’ Participation in Higher Education in Belize: Present Realities*

and its Implications for Policy and Practice [Oral Presentation]. Belize KULCHA Symposium, Heritage Education Network, Belize.

9. Penados, F., Rosado, L., **Lee-Shi, J.**, & Tzib, D. (2025, September). *Indigenous Peoples in Higher Education: A Diagnostic – Belize* [Oral Presentation]. Second General Meeting, Ciencia y Tecnologia, International Development Research Centre, Costa Rica.
8. **Lee-Shi, J.**, & Ley, R. G. (2025, May). *From Adversity to Trauma: Examining and Elaborating the Hybrid Model of Stress Response as Applied to Belizean Contexts* [Paper presentation, Symposium]. Inaugural Conference on Critical Social Justice in Psychology, Vancouver, BC, Canada.
7. **Lee-Shi, J.**, & Ley, R. G. (2025, April). *The Double-Edged Sword of Social Support: Protective and Risk Factors in Trauma Recovery in Belize* [Oral presentation]. 22nd Hawai'i International Summit on Preventing, Assessing & Treating Trauma Across the Lifespan, Hawaii, USA.
6. **Lee-Shi, J.**, & Wong, M. (2024, May). *Cognitive Emotion Regulation in Depression: Potential Insights from Natural Language Processing Analyses*. [Poster presentation]. Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies: Annual Student Research Symposium (ABCT), Virtual Conference.
5. **Lee-Shi, J.**, & Fouladi, R. T. (2024, April). *Defining Resilience Beyond Trauma and Violence in Belizean Communities*. [Poster presentation]. Justice, Reconciliation, Equity, Diversity, Accessibility, and Inclusion (JEDAI) Research Fair, Burnaby, BC, Canada.
4. **Lee-Shi, J.** (2024, March). *Exploring the Psychology of Gang Involvement and Its Impact on the Community*. [Data Blitz presentation]. 2024 Criminal Minds – An Interdisciplinary Conference, Burnaby, BC, Canada.
3. **Lee-Shi, J.**, & Fouladi, R. T. (2023, May). *Manual Text Feature and Machine-Learning Analyses on Think-Aloud Concussion Assessment Transcriptions: Who Finds What Confusing?* [Poster presentation]. Connecting Minds Research Conference, Richmond, BC, Canada.
2. **Lee-Shi, J.**, Ley, R. G., Cox, D., & Sugarman, J. (2022, June). *A Pilot Study: Differences in Flow State and Flow Disposition in Jazz vs. Classical Musicians and their Practice* [Poster presentation]. Annual Canadian Psychological Association Convention, Calgary, AB, Canada.
1. **Lee-Shi, J.**, Ley, R. G., Cox, D., & Sugarman, J. (2022, March). *Differences in Flow State and Flow Disposition in Jazz vs. Classical Musicians and their Practice*. In *Putting On a Show: Sports and Music* [Symposium]. Simon Fraser University Undergraduate Research Symposium, Burnaby, BC, Canada.

OTHER PRESENTATIONS [3]

3. Penados, F., Rosado, L., Tzib, D., & **Lee-Shi, J.** (2026, June). *Indigenous Participation in Higher Education: Key Findings and Recommendations* [Roundtable Presentation]. Galen University, Belize.

2. Penados, F., Rosado, L., Tzib, D., & **Lee-Shi, J.** (2025, October). *Advancing Inclusive Policies for Indigenous Participation in Higher Education: Present Realities and Implications* [Oral Presentation]. Indigenous Resistance Day Lecture and Workshop, University of Belize, Belmopan, Belize.
1. **Lee-Shi, J.**, Barrett, R., & Aldenhoven, L. M. (2024, July). *Gender Minorities and Crisis Support in Vancouver: Perceptions and Impacts* [Poster presentation]. Burnaby Pride Festival, Burnaby, BC, Canada.

CLINICAL TRAINING

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| 11/2024 | Stress and Trauma: An Attachment-Based Perspective
Training by Gordon Neufeld, Ph.D., R. Psych |
| 10/2024 | Trauma-informed Supports for Autism
Presented by Alexia Stack and Ben Reiman (M.A., BCBAs) |
| 02/2024 | Indigenous Approaches to Trauma and Wellness
Training by Karlee Fellner, Ph.D., R. Psych |

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE FOR RESEARCH PURPOSES

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| Summer 2024 | Research Interviewer
<i>Trauma, Coping and Post-traumatic Changes Study in Belize</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Based on Grounded Theory and IPA principles, designed, conducted, and analyzed semi-structured interviews (N = 12, adults, 1-3 hours each), on adversity/trauma, coping, post-stressor changes <u>Supervisor:</u> Dr. Robert G. Ley |
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CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

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| 29/08/2026 | Program Co-Facilitator, Peer Advocacy & Leadership:
<i>Psychological First Aid Training for Youth, Belize City Lions Club</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Supervise and co-lead a Psychological First Aid Training workshop |
| 05/2025 – 10/2025 | Peer Navigator, GOJoven Belize Alumni Association <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Provide HIV testing and pre-/post-test counselling • Deliver peer counselling to one client: psychoeducation on stress responses, guidance in identifying coping strategies and sources of stress |
| 07/2025 – 09/2025 | Program Co-Facilitator, Strong Roots, Brave Voices, META Belize <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Co-led a trauma-focused cognitive behavioural therapy (TF-CBT) group for Belizean adolescents experiencing grief <u>Facilitator:</u> Azalia G. Larrieu, LCSW, MSW, CCTS-I |
| 01/2024 – 04/2025 | Career Development Mentor in Behaviour Intervention, Metro Vancouver, Canada |

- Facilitate discussions on ethical practices, effective client (parent and child) engagement, and career challenges

10/2023 – 11/2024 **Senior Behaviour Interventionist**, Metro Vancouver, Canada

- Implemented one-on-one ABA intervention plans, to foster adaptive behaviours, communication, social skills, and self-regulation in children (aged 4 – 8) with ASD
- Recruited, supervised, and trained behaviour interventionists

Supervisor: Zoë Liu M.Ed. BCBA

02/2022 – 12/2023 **Behaviour Interventionist**, Metro Vancouver, Canada

- Implemented individualized ABA- and ESDM-based behaviour interventions for children (aged 3 – 12) with ASD and ADHD

Supervisors: Zoë Liu, Yvonne Kong, Karla Suarez (M.Ed. BCBAs)

ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Graduate Level

Spring 2024 **Invited Guest Lecturer** – PSYC 770 – Proseminar in Personality, SFU

Instructor: Dr. Robert G. Ley

Lecture Topic: The Big Five Personality Traits

Undergraduate Level

Fall 2026 **Lecturer (Sessional)**, University of Belize, Belize

Course: Research Methods

Spring 2026 **Psychology Lecturer (Sessional)**, St John's College – University, Belize

Courses: Industrial and Organizational Psychology, Behavioral Genetics, Adolescent Development, Neuropsychology, Research in Psychology

Spring 2025, Summer 2024 **Teaching Assistant (TA) and TA Mentor** – PSYC 201W – Introduction to Research Methods in Psychology, SFU

Fall 2024, Spring 2024, Fall 2023 **Teaching Assistant** – PSYC 201W, SFU

VOLUNTEERING

2025 – Present, 2012 – 2016 **Belize National Orchestra**, Belize
Position: Wind Section Mentor, Principal Flautist

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

09/2025 – Present **Board Member**, Mental Health Association, Belize

2024 – 2025 **Graduate Student Member**, American Psychological Association, Division 56 Trauma Psychology